

Record 8 - Alpine Orthopedic Surgery - New Patient Consultation

Date of Service: 04/23/2026

Provider: Dr. R. Whitfield, MD

Patient referred by Dr. Kowalski for full-thickness right rotator cuff tear on MRI, now approximately 11 weeks after injury.

HPI as above. Patient reports significant impact on activities of daily living and inability to perform his usual work duties. Notes he lives alone and has had to rely on a neighbor for help with household tasks requiring overhead reaching.

Physical exam: Positive drop arm test. Weakness with resisted external rotation, 3/5. Painful arc. MRI reviewed, confirms full-thickness supraspinatus tear with mild retraction.

Assessment: Full-thickness right rotator cuff (supraspinatus) tear, now chronic given delay to diagnosis, with mild tendon retraction noted on imaging.

Plan: Discussed surgical repair options given failure of conservative management and imaging findings. Risks of delayed repair discussed, including increased risk of retraction, fatty infiltration, and potentially more limited surgical options/outcomes the longer repair is delayed. Patient elects to proceed with surgical repair. Surgery scheduled.

Prescriptions Written Today: None today; pre-operative instructions provided.
